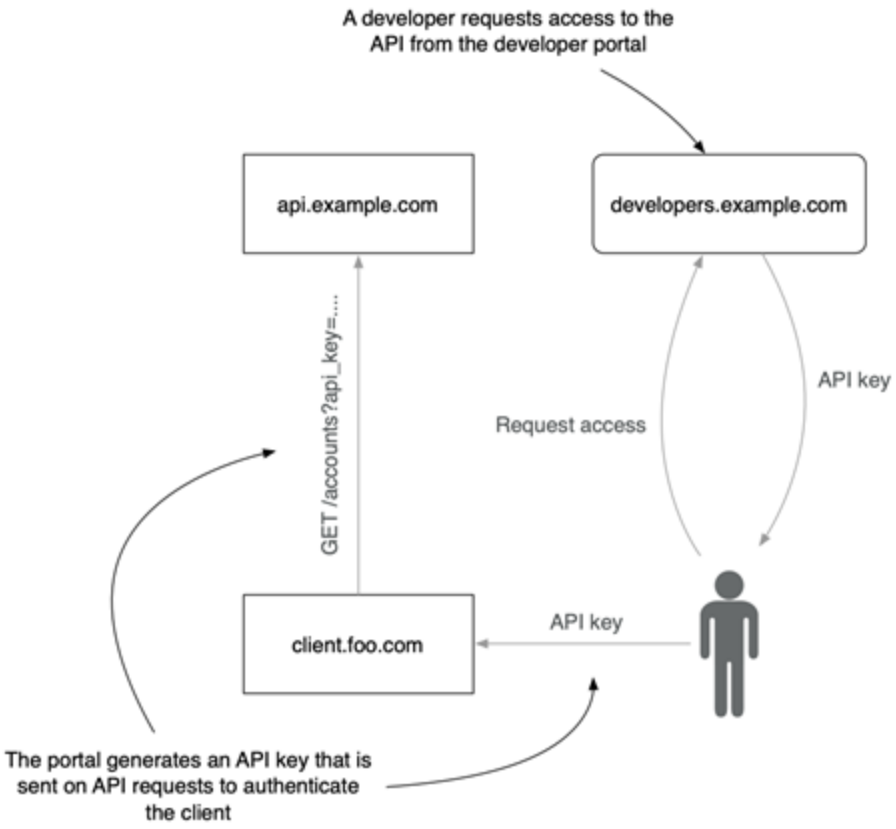



**Figure 11.1 To gain access to an API a representative of the organization logs into a developer portal and requests an API key. The portal generates the API key and returns it. The developer then includes the API key as a query parameter on requests to the API.**

Section 11.5 covers techniques for securely deploying API keys and other credentials. The API key is added to each request as a request parameter or custom header.

> **DEFINITION** An ***API key*** is a token that identifies a service client rather than a user. API keys are typically valid for a much longer time than a user token, often months or years.